A Short Adventure Time Story That Became Very Big

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Some cartoon bad guys are just silly. The Ice King is different: funny, sad, and a little scary all at once.

A new look back at Adventure Time calls one episode from 13 years ago a **masterpiece**. It is "Simon & Marcy," season 5, episode 14, ten minutes long.

At first, the Ice King seemed simple. He lived with his penguins, used ice powers, and tried to catch princesses. Finn and Jake usually stopped him.

Then, in season 4, episode 25, "Remember Me," Marceline, the **vampire** queen, calls him Simon for the first time. That hints at a past we had not seen.

"Simon & Marcy" shows part of that past. It is a **flashback** set almost 1,000 years before the story. After the Mushroom War changed Earth into Ooo, Simon travels through a **ruined** city with Marcy, and they look after each other.

His magic crown gives him ice powers but makes thinking hard. Singing the Cheers theme seems to help. The episode explains Simon and Marceline and led to more stories across nearly 300 episodes and a **spinoff**.

Word Treasure

masterpiece -- A work people call the very best of its kind.

flashback -- A scene that shows something from the past.

spinoff -- A new show made from characters or stories in an older show.

vampire -- A story creature that drinks blood and lives a very long time.

ruined -- Broken and damaged, no longer in good shape.

Background you need

The Ice King is a cartoon villain who is funny, sad, and a little scary all at once.

An old episode shows his past, when he was Simon traveling with Marcy after the Mushroom War changed Earth into Ooo.

His magic crown gives him ice powers but makes thinking hard.

Break it down

WHO: The Ice King (Simon), Marcy (Marceline), Finn, and Jake.
WHAT: A look back at an Adventure Time episode called a masterpiece.
WHERE: Ooo, the world Earth became after the Mushroom War.
WHY: The episode explains Simon and Marceline's past and led to more stories.

Why it matters

Great stories can hide a sad past inside a funny character, and noticing that makes cartoons even more fun to watch.

Test what you remember

1. Which episode does a new look back call a masterpiece?

- (A) The last episode
- (B) "Remember Me," season 4, episode 25
- (C) The first episode
- (D) "Simon & Marcy," season 5, episode 14

2. How long is "Simon & Marcy"?

- (A) Five minutes long
- (B) One hour long
- (C) Ten minutes long
- (D) Thirty minutes long

3. Who calls the Ice King "Simon" for the first time?

- (A) A penguin
- (B) Jake
- (C) Marceline, the vampire queen
- (D) Finn

4. What is "Simon & Marcy" set as?

- (A) A dream
- (B) A future vision
- (C) A flashback almost 1,000 years before the story
- (D) A song

5. What changed Earth into Ooo?

- (A) A magic spell
- (B) A flood
- (C) An earthquake
- (D) The Mushroom War

6. What does Simon's magic crown do?

- (A) Lets him fly
- (B) Makes him invisible
- (C) Turns him into a penguin
- (D) Gives him ice powers but makes thinking hard

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: C 4: C 5: D 6: D

Questions to think about

1. A new look back at Adventure Time: Calls "Simon & Marcy" a masterpiece.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):